QUICK START GUIDE · EDITION 1.0

AI Job-Search Assistant

The main steps in four pages, for readers who have read the full handbook once. Every step names the handbook chapter with the details.

Before you start · The steps · Everyday commands · Top fixes

Before you start

- 64-bit PC/laptop with VT-x/AMD-V, **8 GB+ RAM** (4 GB: Debian only, small model), SSD preferred, wired Ethernet, on charger.
- USB stick (4 GB+, will be erased) and a second device with a browser.
- Free accounts: Telegram, Reed developer key, (optional) Adzuna, Tailscale.
- The package `ai-job-agent.zip`.

PROXMOX HOST

```
root@pve:~#   (orange) host commands
```

CONTAINER

```
root@agent-box:~#   (teal) container commands
```

Replace every `YOUR_...` placeholder with your own value. Never share `.env`.

> **Scope**
>
> The system finds, filters, AI-scores and reports jobs (tracker + Telegram). It does not tailor CVs, ask for approval or apply: you review and apply yourself.

The steps

1. Prepare the computer (Handbook ch. 5)

Back up the disk (it will be erased). Enable Intel VT-x / AMD-V in the BIOS. Note your gateway and a free IP address.

2. Install Proxmox VE (ch. 6)

Download the ISO from https://www.proxmox.com/en/downloads, write it to USB with Rufus (DD mode) or balenaEtcher, boot it, choose ext4, set password and static IP. Then open `https://YOUR_SERVER_IP:8006`, log in as root, add the **No-Subscription** repository, disable the enterprise ones, and update.

Laptops: set `HandleLidSwitch=ignore` and `HandleLidSwitchExternalPower=ignore` in `/etc/systemd/logind.conf`; USB system disk: add `usbcore.autosuspend=-1` to `GRUB_CMDLINE_LINUX_DEFAULT`, run `update-grub`, reboot, check `/proc/cmdline`.

3. Copy the package to the host (ch. 7)

YOUR PC

```
scp ai-job-agent.zip root@YOUR_SERVER_IP:/root/
```

PROXMOX HOST

```
apt install -y unzip && cd /root && unzip -o ai-job-agent.zip
```

4. Template and network (ch. 7)

local > CT Templates > Templates > **debian-13-standard ... amd64** > Download. Home router: Option A (vmbr0). Network that blocks new devices: Option B:

PROXMOX HOST

```
bash /root/ai-job-agent/host/setup-nat-bridge.sh
```

5. Create the container (ch. 7)

Setting	Value (16 GB / 8 GB)
General	CT 100, hostname agent-box, Unprivileged ☑, Nesting ☑
Disk / CPU / RAM / swap	50 GB / 6 cores / 12288 / 4096 · 30-40 GB / all-but-1 / 6144 / 2048
Network A	vmbr0, DHCP
Network B	vmbr1, 10.10.10.100/24, gateway 10.10.10.1, DNS 1.1.1.1
Options	Start at boot ☑; Features: nesting, keyctl

For Tailscale, append to `/etc/pve/lxc/100.conf`:

/ETC/PVE/LXC/100.CONF

```
lxc.cgroup2.devices.allow: c 10:200 rwm
lxc.mount.entry: /dev/net/tun dev/net/tun none bind,create=file
```

Start it, then:

PROXMOX HOST

```
pct push 100 /root/ai-job-agent.zip /root/ai-job-agent.zip
pct enter 100
```

CONTAINER

```
apt update && apt upgrade -y && ping -c 3 deb.debian.org && hostname -I
```

6. Docker and Tailscale (ch. 8)

CONTAINER

```
apt install -y curl ca-certificates unzip
curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com | sh
docker run --rm hello-world
```

```
curl -fsSL https://tailscale.com/install.sh | sh && tailscale up     # optional
tailscale ip -4
```

7. Install the project (ch. 9)

CONTAINER

```
cd /root && unzip -o ai-job-agent.zip && cd ai-job-agent
bash install.sh                # or --minimal  (8 GB)   or --minimal --model qwen2.5:1.5b
(4 GB)
docker ps
```

8. NocoDB tracker (ch. 10)

Open `http://ADDRESS:8081`, create the admin account, base **Job Agent**, table **Applications**. Rename Title to **Company** and add: **Role** (text), **Link** (URL), **Source** (text), **Match Score** (number), **Status** (single select: Found, Tailored, Approved, Applied, Skipped, Manual, Rejected, Interview), **CV File** (text), **Applied At** (date-time), **Notes** (long text), **Job ID** (text). Create an API token; find the table ID (starts with *m*).

9. Keys into .env (ch. 11-12)

Telegram: **@BotFather** > `/newbot` > copy token; `/setjoingroups` > Disable; press Start in your bot and send "hello". Reed: https://www.reed.co.uk/developers/jobseeker. Adzuna (optional): https://developer.adzuna.com (App ID = short 8-character ID).

CONTAINER

```
nano /opt/stacks/jobagent/.env          # REED, ADZUNA, TELEGRAM_TOKEN, NOCODB_TOKEN,
NOCODB_TABLE_ID
cd /opt/stacks/jobagent && docker compose up -d --build
docker exec jobagent python /data/tools/get_chat_id.py
nano /opt/stacks/jobagent/.env          # TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID
docker compose up -d --force-recreate
docker exec jobagent python /data/tools/check_setup.py --send
```

Wanted: **All required checks passed.** and a test message on your phone.

10. Your profile, preferences and first run (ch. 14)

CONTAINER

```
nano /opt/jobagent/cv/master.md         # your TRUE profile, <1,500 words
nano /opt/jobagent/cv/answers.yaml      # your true fixed answers
nano /opt/jobagent/app/config.json      # keywords, filters, location, threshold
python3 -m json.tool /opt/jobagent/app/config.json > /dev/null && echo OK
docker restart jobagent
docker exec -d jobagent sh -c "python /data/app/finder.py --once >> /data/state/run.log
2>&1"
tail -f /opt/jobagent/state/run.log
```

Then: read each Telegram match and advert yourself, check it is genuine, update **Status** in NocoDB, apply manually with a CV you have checked (never add anything untrue), and record **Applied** + **Applied At**. Runs then happen automatically at 07:30 and 18:30.

Everyday commands

Task	Command (container)
Status	`docker ps`
Scheduler log	`docker logs -f jobagent`
Run now	`docker exec jobagent python /data/app/finder.py --once`
After editing config.json / master.md	`docker restart jobagent`
After editing .env	`cd /opt/stacks/jobagent && docker compose up -d --force-recreate`
Update apps	`docker compose pull && docker compose up -d` in each stack folder
Re-score everything	`rm /opt/jobagent/state/seen.json`
Backup (host)	`vzdump 100 --mode snapshot --compress zstd --storage local`

Top fixes

Symptom	Fix
Proxmox page times out after moving house	Update address/gateway in `/etc/network/interfaces` and `/etc/hosts`; `ifreload -a`; `systemctl restart pveproxy`
apt "Hash Sum mismatch" in container	Captive portal: use Network Option B
"Detected container architecture: arm64"	Recreate with the amd64 template
Docker fails in container	Enable nesting + keyctl, restart container
"network shared … not found"	Start `/opt/stacks/ai` first
Input/output error everywhere	USB disk dropped: hard power-off, charger in, reseat cable, `fsck -y /dev/mapper/pve-root` if emergency mode; fix autosuspend; move to SSD
No Telegram messages	`check_setup.py --send`; press Start in your bot; `get_chat_id.py`
Nothing saved in NocoDB	Field names exactly as step 8; Status option "Found" exists; table ID and token
Open WebUI slow	Turn off tools, web search, code interpreter, title/tag/follow-up generation

Full details: handbook chapter 15 (35 problems). Security: chapter 17. Responsible use: chapter 18.